

Most of these devices also show you the power consumption of every standalone device in the system and how to use it more efficiently, alongside the health status of each of them. If you are building a smart home from scratch, installing a smart HVAC system becomes easier. But if you are not, then you would want to know if an upgrade is worthwhile for you.

Should you upgrade to a smart HVAC?

The device that truly makes your HVAC smart is the thermostat controlling it. There are several smart thermostats from Nest, Ecobee and Honeywell, each with its own set of smart controls and features. Most of these devices learn from and adjust to your behaviour over time. They are connected to the internet and can be remotely connected to your phone too. Another thing that most of these devices have in common is their cost. They all are expensive. All good smart thermostats cost upwards of \$200 (roughly ₹14,000) and that is just their price. If the device is not a plug and play model which can be set up straight out of the box by you, add the cost of calling a professional to install it too.

What you must remember is that a smart HVAC is bound to save you money over the long run, recovering your initial cost over time. So, whether you want a smart HVAC or not depends on how much money and time you are ready to invest in the system. Choose a device that can be set up yourself without the need of a professional and go through tutorials on its installation online. Invest in a smart Thermostat only if you know you will be staying in the same place for a while, or you'll take the device with you if you move to a new house.

If you are doing a complete home automation project or you are one of those forgetful people who often forget to switch off the air conditioning while leaving, then by all means go ahead with and buy it. A smart HVAC system can bring down your electricity bill by as much as 20%. Many people out there using such devices are cutting down your power consumption by almost 1/3rd.

So, let's check out some of the smart HVAC devices available currently.

Smart HVAC devices

There are different categories of smart HVAC devices. First there are smart thermostats that let you control the heating and air conditioning units of your house. And then you have smart vents that complement these smart